

MONSTERS

D&D: EXPERT

Often, well-defended coastal towns will serve as havens for pirates and buccaneers. These are lawless and dangerous places, full of many possible adventures.

Dervish. Dervishes often form into camps or tribes of up to 300 men, led by a 10th level cleric. Such a camp will be of tents (75%) or a wooden or brick stockade (25%). These camps will contain women, children, livestock, and the treasure of the dervishes.

Dervishes are noted for their fanatic belief in their religion and their intolerance of other views. On rare occasions, they will wage a "holy war", in which they will attempt to capture or kill all who have different beliefs. Captives will be given an opportunity to convert; if they refuse, they may be killed or enslaved. Lawful characters may be invited to join the crusade, and those who refuse will be viewed with great suspicion unless a good reason can be provided as to why they should not participate.

Merchant. Merchants are traders who travel in caravans from town to town, selling and buying various goods (wines, silks, jewels, precious metals and the like). Those in the caravan usually ride horses, but they are likely to travel by camel in desert and barren lands and by mule in the mountains. All merchants wear chain mail and carry a sword and dagger.

The following table gives typical caravan organization.

		2nd or 3rd			
		1st Level	Level	5th Level	Extra
Merchants	Wagons	Fighters	Fighters	Fighters	Animals
5	10	20	2	1	1-12
10	20	40	4	1	1-12
15	30	60	6	1	1-12
20	40	80	8	1	1-12

All fighters have Armor Class 4 and carry swords, daggers, and crossbows. The extra animals may be horses, mules, or even camels (DM's choice). If a caravan has less than 20 wagons, the treasure should be reduced accordingly.

Nomads. These groups of wandering tribesmen may be peaceful or warlike and may have any alignment. Small bands encountered hunting or foraging in the wilderness will usually be part of a larger tribe. All treasure will be at the main camp. Nomads are keen traders and often have knowledge of faraway places, though they tend to be superstitious. Nomad bands are organized as follows:

DESERT NOMADS

- 50% Lance, leather armor and shield, riding horse or camel
- 20% Bow, leather armor, riding horse or camel
- 30% Lance, chainmail and shield, riding horse or camel

STEPPE NOMADS

- 20% Lance, leather armor and shield, riding horse
- 50% Bow, leather armor, riding horse
- 20% Bow, chainmail, riding horse
- 10% Lance, chainmail and shield, riding or war horse

For every 25 nomads there will be a 2nd level fighter leading them. For every 40 nomads there will be a 4th level fighter as leader.

Nomad tribes may have up to 300 fighting men gathered together in a camp of temporary huts or tents. In addition to the leaders listed above, there will be one 5th level fighter for every 100 men and an 8th level fighter as the clan or tribe chief. There is also a 50% chance for a 9th level cleric, and a 25% chance for an 8th level magic-user at the main camp.

Mermen

Armor Class:	6	No. Appearing:	0 (1-20)
Hit Dice:	1-4	Save As:	Fighter: 1
Move:	120' (40')	Morale:	8
Attacks:	1	Treasure Type:	A
Damage:	1-6 or by weapon	Alignment:	Neutral

Mermen have the upper bodies of men and the lower bodies of large fish. They are armed with spears, tridents (treat as spears), or daggers. They live in coastal waters and hunt fish and harvest kelp. All mermen (except leaders) have 1 hit die and save as 1st level fighters.

The number appearing represents a small hunting party, although mermen will often form underwater villages of 100 to 300 creatures. For every 10 mermen encountered there will be a leader with 2 hit dice. For every 50 there will be one leader with 4 hit dice. Mermen leaders save as fighters with the same amount of hit dice (i.e. a 4 hit dice merman saves as a fighter: 4).

Mermen often keep trained marine animals and monsters to help guard their homes (DM's discretion).

Mummy*

Armor Class:	3	No. Appearing:	1-4 (1-12)
Hit Dice:	5 + 1*	Save As:	Fighter: 5
Move:	60' (20')	Morale:	12
Attacks:	1 touch + disease	Treasure Type:	D
Damage:	1-12 + disease	Alignment:	Chaotic

Mummies are **undead** who lurk near deserted ruins and tombs. On seeing a mummy, each character must save vs. paralysis or be paralyzed with fear until the mummy attacks someone or goes out of sight. In melee, a hit by a mummy does 1-12 points of damage and infects the creature hit with a hideous rotting disease. This disease prevents magical healing and makes all wounds take 10 times as long to heal. The disease lasts until it is magically cured.

Mummies can only be damaged by spells, fire, or magic weapons, all of which will only do half damage. They are immune to **sleep**, **charm**, and **hold** spells.

Nixies

Armor Class:	7	No. Appearing:	0 (2-40)
Hit Dice:	1	Save As:	Elf: 1
Move:	120' (40')	Morale:	6
Attacks:	1	Treasure Type:	B
Damage:	1-4	Alignment:	Neutral

Nixies are 3' tall water sprites. They look like small beautiful women, and their skin is light blue, green, or gray-green. They avoid combat, but may try to **charm** an adventurer. Ten nixies can cast one such **charm**, and if a save vs. Spells is not made, the victim will enter the water and serve the nixies for a year. (Each nixie can cast a **water breathing** spell on her slave, but this must be renewed every day.)

If forced to fight, nixies use small tridents (treat as spears) and daggers, and each will summon a giant bass to aid them (AC 7, HD 2, MV 120' (40'), #AT 1, D 1-6, Save F1, ML 8, AL N).

Nixies dwell in rivers and lakes, making their lairs in the deepest part of the water.